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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 5 : Session – 2 | Definitiveness of Ethical Human Conduct

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. DEFINITIVENESS OF ETHICAL HUMAN CONDUCT: because values are definite (rooted in reality — co-existence, natural acceptance), the CONDUCT flowing from right understanding is also definite: it does not change with time, place, person or circumstance. A person with right understanding is honest with the stranger as with the friend, in private as in public, today as ten years hence. This definitiveness is the test of ethics: conduct that varies with convenience is policy or pretence, not value. Ethical conduct is therefore universal, rational, naturally acceptable and all-encompassing — the same for every human being.
2. Q2. THE TRIO — VALUES, POLICY, CHARACTER: VALUES are my understanding of what is valuable (the existential content — trust, respect, right utilisation). POLICY (niti) is my decision-rule for living: to nurture and protect — the policy of enrichment toward all, derived from values. CHARACTER (charitra) is the steadiness of my actual living: chastity in conjugal relationship, right utilisation of wealth/produce, and kindness in behaviour and work. Values are in understanding, policy in intention/decision, character in conduct — ethical human conduct is complete only when all three align: right values -> definite policy -> consistent character.
3. Q3. WHY ethical conduct is simultaneously SELF-SATISFYING, PEOPLE-FRIENDLY and ECO-FRIENDLY: SELF-SATISFYING because it is in line with my own natural acceptance — there is no contradiction between what I am and what I want to be, so it gives happiness in continuity, not guilt or anxiety. PEOPLE-FRIENDLY because conduct based on trust, respect and justice fulfils the other's need of the Self — it can only nurture, never exploit, other human beings. ECO-FRIENDLY because right utilisation and protection of nature are intrinsic to it — it enriches the orders it draws from. One conduct, three harmonised outcomes — because all three are expressions of the same understanding of co-existence.
4. Q4. ANALYSIS OF A RECENT DECISION: whether to share my assignment code with a classmate who had fallen behind. Sensation/preconditioning said: refuse (competition for grades) or blindly hand over (avoid awkwardness). Value-based analysis: the other's need is GUIDANCE (right understanding), not merely a submission — affection and care mean ensuring his competence grows. Decision: I sat with him, explained the approach, and let him write his own code. Outcome: he learned, our trust deepened, and I felt no contradiction — the decision satisfied all three tests: self-satisfying, people-friendly, and (in using shared resources fairly) responsible.